IMPACT MATCH™

ActionAble

LEIGH SMYTH

INSPIRING ORGANISATIONS TO TURN PURPOSE INTO IMPACT

Award-Winning Founder | ImpactMatch CEO | Inclusion Pioneer | International Speaker | #MadebyDyslexia | Chair | Impact Judge

WHO IS LEIGH?

Leigh Smyth FRSA is one of the UK's most credible voices on social impact, inclusion and responsible transformation: a founder and operator who has spent two decades turning bold ideas into national infrastructure.

Leigh does not speak about change from the sidelines. She has built it at scale, inside government, FTSE business and the charity sector.

As Founder & CEO of ImpactMatch, Co-Founder of ActionAble and a former Responsible Transformation Director at Lloyds Banking Group, she brings people together around complex challenges and turns ideas into practical action.

At A Glance

- Founder & CEO ImpactMatch
- Co-Founder ActionAble
- Former Responsible Transformation Director Lloyds Banking Group
- Trustee AbilityNet

Over **two decades** of turning ideas into **action**

1M+	24,500	£10M+	3 PM’s	12+
People trained through the Lloyds Bank Digital Academy	Colleague Digital Champions mobilised - largest corporate movement in Europe. Inspired many orgs to do the same	Pro-bono support secured for inclusion initiatives. Including a TV campaign.	Met with three Prime Ministers to secure support for social mobility.	Awards & finalist recognitions Including Global Good Awards Bronze and Zero Project finalist recognition.

WHAT LEIGH IS KNOWN FOR

From intention to action

INCLUSION

Building systems that work for people who are often excluded.

DIGITAL & TECHNOLOGY

Making technology accessible, useful and human.

SOCIAL IMPACT

Turning purpose into programmes, partnerships and measurable outcomes.

RESPONSIBLE TRANSFORMATION

Helping organisations connect transformation with real-world impact.

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

Bringing senior leaders, organisations and communities together to create change.

TOPICS LEIGH SPEAKS ABOUT

How organisations can make emerging technology more human, accessible and inclusive. How leaders can build workplaces where different experiences and abilities become strengths. What it takes to move beyond access and build the skills, confidence and opportunity people need to participate. How organisations can make transformation deliver meaningful outcomes for customers, colleagues and communities. How to turn purpose into partnerships, programmes and measurable change. Moving disability inclusion from intention to practical organisational action. Helping leaders pivot to purpose and leave a legacy of impact.

AI, Technology & Inclusion

Future Skills & Digital Mindset

Accessibility by Design

Responsible Transformation

Purpose-Led Leadership & Pivoting to Purpose

Impact Coalition & Partnership Building

BUILDING COALITIONS THAT MOVE INCLUSION FORWARD

ACTIONABLE

Co-Founder of ActionAble, bringing together senior leaders from major UK employers and leading disability organisations around workplace and customer inclusion.

DEAF EQUITY

Author of the Deaf Equity in Financial Services 2026 Annual Report, bringing together evidence from 30+ financial-services organisations and the lived experience of Deaf BSL users.

CONNECTED BRITAIN

Helped shape the People programme at a major UK technology event reaching approximately 8,000 delegates, while bringing 32 diverse leaders onto the People Zone.

BOARD & C-SUITE LEADERSHIP

Works alongside boards and C-suite leaders to turn social challenges into practical, measurable action. Earlier work included helping bring children's laptops into UK retail and widening equitable access for children receiving free school meals.

BUILT AT NATIONAL & GLOBAL SCALE

1. 2005–2012 | NATIONAL DIGITAL INCLUSION

Worked alongside Baroness Martha Lane Fox, recruited 1,200 partners and helped establish the National Digital Champion model.

2. 2012–2018 | LLOYDS BANKING GROUP

Created the Digital Skills Academy, which has trained 1M+ people for free, and built a 24,500-member Digital Champion network.

3. 2019–2023 | ADVISORY & SECTOR LEADERSHIP

Advised the UN Environment Programme Finance Initiative, held an Executive Volunteer Director role with the Tech Talent Charter, helped establish the Digital Poverty Alliance and led Financial Wellbeing challenge groups for the Money & Pensions Service.

4. 2024–PRESENT | IMPACTMATCH & ACTIONABLE

Founded ImpactMatch and co-founded ActionAble, designing the Disability Dividend framework to help organisations turn disability inclusion into measurable business and social impact. Led evidence-based programmes across disability and Deaf equity.

5. CURRENT WORK | EVIDENCE & RECOGNITION

Author of the ActionAble Impact Report 2025 and Deaf Equity in Financial Services 2026 Annual Report, with the latter winning Global Good Awards Bronze and a Zero Project Award 2027 shortlisted initiative. Chairs and speaks at major national events including Connected Britain and Digital Leaders.

PUBLISHED AUTHOR & THOUGHT LEADER

For more than 15 years, Leigh has turned emerging inclusion challenges into evidence, measurement, frameworks and practical action, influencing business, industry and public-policy thinking.

2026 | DEAF EQUITY & CURRENT COMMENTARY

Authored Deaf Equity in Financial Services. WorkingMums article pending; youth employment: “We’re asking young people for experience while refusing to let them gain it.”

2025–26 | ACTIONABLE & DISABILITY DIVIDEND

Authored the ActionAble Impact Report 2025 and created the Disability Dividend framework.

2021–22 | DIGITAL POVERTY & POLICY

Authored the UK Digital Poverty Evidence Interim Review; helped shape Digital Poverty Alliance evidence and contributed to APPG thinking.

2013–18 | EVIDENCE & DIGITAL SKILLS

Led the original Lloyds Consumer Digital Index; published in the New Statesman; helped shape the UK Essential Digital Skills Framework.

2011–14 | NATIONAL DIGITAL INCLUSION

Race Online 2012, Go ON UK and Government Digital Inclusion work.

RECOGNITION

Recognised across digital, technology, finance, inclusion and social impact.

GLOBAL GOOD AWARDS / ZERO PROJECT 2026
Bronze winner and Zero Project finalist for the Deaf Equity in Financial Services programme.

INNOVATE UK GROWTH PROGRAMME 2025
Selected to join the programme to scale ImpactMatch's social impact.

SCOTTISH GOVERNMENT - DIGITAL INCLUSION ALLIANCE 2025
Invited as a volunteer "Disrupter" advisor.

UN FINANCE INITIATIVE - EXPERT ADVISOR 2021
Appointed to set financial-inclusion and financial-health measurement standards for global signatory banks.

INNOVATE FINANCE - STANDOUT 35 / WOMEN IN FINTECH POWERLIST 2021
Recognised among those "moving the needle" on inclusive financial services.

DIGITAL LEADERS 100 - FOUNDERS AWARD 2019
Honoured for long-term contribution to UK digital transformation.

DL100 - UK TOP 10 DIGITAL LEADER 2016
Ranked in the UK's top ten digital leaders.

WOMEN IN BANKING & FINANCE - AWARD FOR ACHIEVEMENT 2016
For mobilising 24,500 volunteers (Largest in Europe for a FTSE) and creating the Consumer Digital Index.

IT PRO - MOST INNOVATIVE CAMPAIGN 2011
For her MD leadership of Race Online 2012 with Baroness Martha Lane Fox.

DBA DESIGN EFFECTIVENESS AWARD 2009
For the user-centred Home Access pilot design that drove a record 91% take-up.

ALSO RECOGNISED AS AN OUTSTANDING CONTRIBUTOR TO THE UK DIGITAL SECTOR AND A TOP 1% LINKEDIN VOICE.

Seeing the gaps others miss

Leigh was the first person in her family to attend university, fought to remain in education at 16 and funded her studies while working three jobs. She also navigated education with then-undiagnosed dyslexia.
That experience shaped the way she approaches leadership:

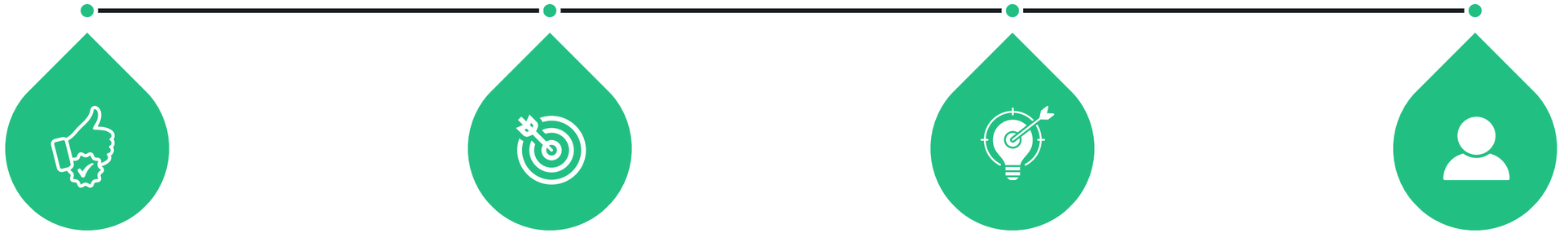
Look for the people and problems the system has overlooked

Then co-design something better.

Today, Leigh brings that perspective to technology, inclusion, leadership and social impact, helping organisations see the human consequences of the decisions they make.

WHY LEIGH?

With 20+ years of experience across National-scale programmes, Cross-sector leadership, Practical frameworks, Compelling storytelling



PRACTICAL

Leigh shares frameworks tested across FTSE business, government, technology and the third sector.

STRATEGIC

She connects board-level thinking with the practical delivery needed to make change happen.

ACTIONABLE

Audiences leave with ideas they can apply, not simply inspiration.

HUMAN

Her talks connect complex issues such as AI, transformation and inclusion back to the people affected by them.

LEIGH HAS WORKED WITH

SPEAKING FORMATS + BOOKING

Leigh is available for

KEYNOTES	High-impact talks designed around the event theme and audience.
PANELS & FIRESIDE CONVERSATIONS	Strategic insight, practical experience and engaging discussion.
WORKSHOPS & MASTERCLASSES	Interactive sessions designed around practical outcomes.
CHAIRING & MODERATION	Connecting diverse perspectives and moving conversations towards action.
VIRTUAL EVENTS	Keynotes, webinars and digital conversations.

What people say about Leigh

Trusted by leaders who have worked with Leigh

Having followed Leigh Smyth's work across the UK's inclusion landscape for some time, I was delighted to invite her to join the 'Grow Skills via volunteering' panel at the annual BCS Digital Divide Specialist Group event in the BCS London office. Leigh is one of those rare speakers who consistently moves the conversation from theory to immediate, measurable action, a trait I've seen repeatedly across her high-profile engagements. Her expertise, forged through pioneering initiatives like the national Digital Academy and her relentless work co-founding ActionAble, which is fundamentally shifting how FTSE companies approach disability inclusion - is peerless. She speaks with a powerful conviction, often framing her own dyslexia as a strategic superpower that allows her to spot the gaps others miss, and she uses this insight to challenge business leaders to embed inclusion as a commercial imperative, as detailed in reports like the Disability Dividend. Leigh's contribution is essential for any professional community committed to systemic, leader-led transformation."

FREDDIE QUEK - CO-DIRECTOR, THE NEXTPATH CONSORTIUM

"Leigh Smyth is, quite simply, a force of nature on stage. Having had the pleasure of working with her as the Chair for our flagship Impact Conference and Awards a number of times, I have seen firsthand her rare ability to command a room.

From her very first words, the energy in the room shifts instantly. Leigh doesn't just speak to an audience; she electrifies them. She brings a powerful blend of consummate professionalism and infectious engagement that keeps everyone hooked from start to finish.
Most importantly, Leigh drives the impact required. She understands the core purpose of an event and ensures that every panel, every introduction, and every keynote aligns to deliver real, actionable value.
If you need a speaker or chair who can elevate your event, inspire a room, and guarantee impactful results, Leigh is the absolute standard."

ROBIN KNOWLES - CEO, DIGITAL LEADERS

What leaders say about Leigh

Trusted by leaders who have worked with Leigh

“Leigh offers social impact board-level skills paired with an unusual and unparalleled entrepreneurial flair. Leigh strategically and efficiently get things done, with a remarkable blend of kindness and care.”

BARONESS MARTHA LANE FOX CBE
PRESIDENT, BRITISH CHAMBERS OF COMMERCE

“I’ve worked with Leigh for 10 years. She has an unrivalled network of change-makers and a relentless focus on ‘doing good by doing good’. By bringing the right people together with the right organisation, Leigh drives social change at scale.”

SARA WELLER CBE
NON-EXECUTIVE & CHAIR, FTSE AND GOVERNMENT

What leaders say about Leigh

Trusted by leaders who have worked with Leigh

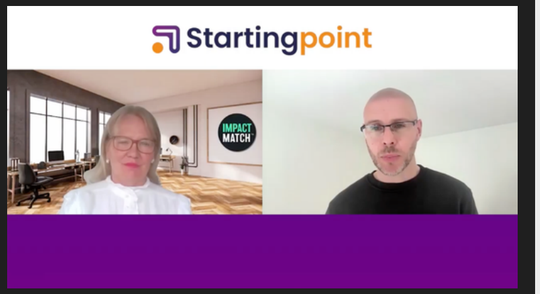
“Leigh’s talk on pivoting to purpose was exceptionally inspiring & thought provoking. It went far beyond just finding your 'why' it showed how aligning your personal purpose with the right people, career choices, and organisations is the real key to achieving optimum impact and, as Leigh so wonderfully puts it, find true work joy! - we had great feedback and the audience was engaged throughout”

RUBI KAUR
Digital Divide Specialist Group Inclusion Officer, BCS

MEDIA & **PODCASTS**

[A Beginner's Guide to Being a Grown Up PodCast: “Owning My Ambition Changed Everything” - Leigh Smyth]

[Starting Point: Quick Fire Hire with Leigh Smyth FRSA]



[The Doctor Tech Show: Season 6: Ep 7: with Leigh Smyth, of Impact Match and ActionAble]

[Pivot to Impact: Turning Digital Skills into Purpose, Inclusion and Impact]

BOOK LEIGH

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Scan to connect on Linkedin

SHORT-LENGTH BIO

Leigh Smyth FRSA is the Founder of ImpactMatch and a pioneer in digital inclusion, social impact and responsible transformation. As the UK's first Responsible Transformation Director at Lloyds Banking Group, she created the Digital Skills Academy that has trained over one million people for free, and the Consumer Digital Index, still the UK's largest measure of digital capability. She helped establish the Digital Poverty Alliance, advised the United Nations on financial inclusion, and co-founded ActionAble with Sara Weller CBE to drive workplace disability inclusion. An award-winning international speaker, chair and impact judge, Leigh turns purpose into measurable impact.

MEDIUM-LENGTH BIO

Leigh Smyth FRSA is the Founder and CEO of ImpactMatch and one of the UK's leading voices on inclusion, social impact and responsible transformation. Her career has been defined by a single idea: that inclusion is not a charity problem to be managed, but a systems problem to be solved - by business, government and communities together.

Leigh introduced the UK's first children's technology range through retail, then helped design the Government's Home Access Programme, whose pilot achieved an exceptional 91% take-up and led to a national rollout reaching 267,000 low-income households. As Managing Director of Race Online 2012, she worked alongside Baroness Martha Lane Fox to take digital inclusion to the heart of Downing Street and build the National Digital Champion model still in use today.

At Lloyds Banking Group she became the UK's first Responsible Transformation Director, creating the Digital Skills Academy (over one million people trained for free), the Consumer Digital Index (the UK's benchmark for digital capability for a decade) and the first FTSE accessibility accreditation, achieved with AbilityNet. She later advised the United Nations Environment Programme Finance Initiative on global standards for financial inclusion.

Today Leigh runs ImpactMatch, co-leads the ActionAble disability-inclusion campaign with Sara Weller CBE, and serves as a trustee of AbilityNet. She is an award-winning keynote speaker, conference chair and awards judge whose work sits at the intersection of impact, innovation and inclusion.

FULL-LENGTH BIO (1/2)

Leigh Smyth FRSA is the Founder and CEO of ImpactMatch and an award-winning pioneer in inclusion, inclusive talent and social-impact strategy. For two decades she has been a change-maker at the heart of bringing greater inclusion to marginalised and disadvantaged groups across the UK - not as a commentator, but as the architect of programmes that now reach millions.

Leigh's story begins with grit. The first in her family to attend university, she fought to stay in education at sixteen, funded her studies with three jobs, and navigated then-undiagnosed dyslexia - an experience that shaped a lifelong drive for fairness and a talent for seeing the gaps others miss. After an early career in retail leadership, she chose to "start again" in social impact, determined to create change at scale.

She launched the UK's first children's technology range designed for home learning, then brought that consumer insight to Government as a specialist advisor on the Home Access Programme. Her user-centred "consumer model" - letting low-income families choose their own technology with dignity - delivered a remarkable 91% pilot take-up, earned a DBA Design Effectiveness Award, and underpinned a national rollout to 267,000 households and almost 19,000 schools.

As Managing Director of Race Online 2012, Leigh worked alongside Baroness Martha Lane Fox to secure £4m of pro-bono support, recruit 1,200 partners and launch the "Networked Nation" at No.10 - building the National Digital Champion model that endures today and was echoed across Europe.

FULL-LENGTH BIO (2/2)

At Lloyds Banking Group she established the first-ever FTSE Responsible Transformation function. There she created the Digital Skills Academy, which has trained more than one million people for free; ideated the Consumer Digital Index, which for ten years has been the UK's primary benchmark for digital and financial capability; built Europe's largest corporate Digital Champion network of 24,500 colleagues; and led Lloyds to become the first UK FTSE to achieve full accessibility accreditation with AbilityNet. She also co-developed the UK's first Basic Digital Skills benchmark, now embedded in national policy.

Leigh's influence reaches well beyond the UK. As lead expert volunteer advisor to the United Nations Environment Programme Finance Initiative, she helped 27 global banks design the first universal framework for financial-inclusion target setting. Her UK models have been replicated as far afield as New Zealand.

She helped establish the Digital Poverty Alliance, has served on the boards of the Tech Talent Charter and Women in Banking & Finance, led 11 cross-sector challenge groups for the Money & Pensions Service, and now serves as a trustee of AbilityNet. In 2025 she co-founded ActionAble with Sara Weller CBE - a digital-first disability-inclusion campaign that reached organisations representing four million employees and launched its impact report at the House of Lords with EY.

From designing inclusive strategies to building the teams that deliver them, Leigh's work sits at the intersection of impact, innovation and inclusion - making her a vital voice on the future of leadership, skills and responsible business.

BOOK LEIGH

LEIGH SMYTH FRSA

LET'S CREATE THE RIGHT CONVERSATION